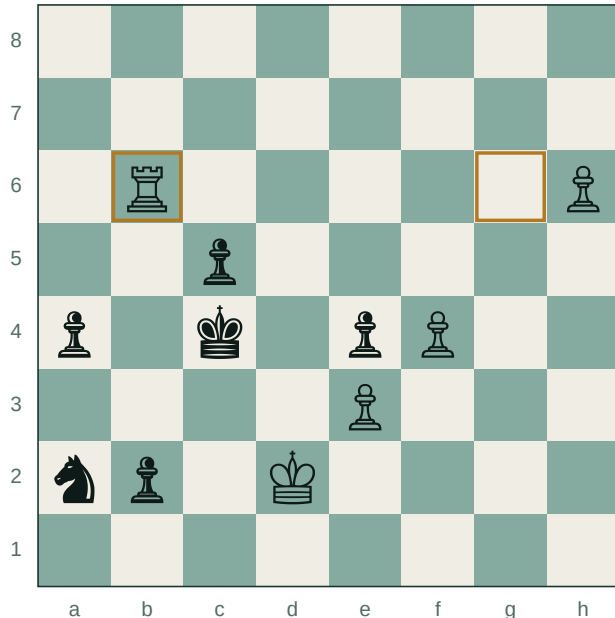


Quiet tactical moves: Black, move 48

Quiet tactical moves

Black to move



Previous move: 48.Rb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

48...Nb4 49. Rxb4+ Kxb4 50. Kc2 Ka3 51. h7 Ka2

48...Nb4 The knight moves from a2 to b4. Recorded reply: **49.Rxb4+**.

49...Kxb4 The king captures the rook on b4. Recorded reply: **50.Kc2**.

50...Ka3 The king moves from b4 to a3. Recorded reply: **51.h7**.

51...Ka2 The king moves from a3 to a2.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on d2. Geometrically undefended: rook on b6. Check for tactical protection.